य एवं वेदा -The One Who Knows Thus

Abstract

This research work examines the Vedic expression *"Ya Evam Vēda"* - "He who knows thus" to reveal the intrinsic relationship between sound, consciousness, and divine manifestation. Through an analysis of the phonetic and semantic structure of the Vedic Vēdāksharas, it shows how sacred speech (*Vēda-vāk*) enables the awakening of divine awareness within the human mind. Drawing on sources such as the *RigVēda* (1.164.39) and *Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa* (3.10.9.14), the study interprets the mantra "ऋचो अक्षरे परमे व्योमन्" as expressing the unity of Brahman, divine power, and articulated sound. The *akṣara* (Vēdākshara) is described as the audible embodiment of transcendental energy, made manifest through mind, effort, and breath. Contemplation of the Vēdākshara, therefore, becomes an act of *tapas*, a meditative discipline that reveals the divine essence underlying all language and knowledge.

Keywords: *Akṣara*, *Vēda-vāk*, Brahman, consciousness, sound symbolism, *RigVēda*, *Ya Evam Vēda*, *tapas*, divine manifestation.

Introduction

Ya (य) signifies *effort* (yathna) and *yajna* (yajña).
Evam (एवम्) comprises the Vēdāksharas *a* (अ) and *i* (इ). The Vēdākshara *a* denotes the primordial energy, while *i* signifies the present moment or the indication of time. The Vēdākshara *va* refers to the attainment of divine consciousness through the Vedic Word (*Vēda-vāk*). Thus, *ya evam Vēda* conveys the meaning:
"In this sacred act (yajña), may my mind through the assistance of the Vedic Word attain divine awareness within me."
This is the interpretive meaning of the phrase.

The Nature of the Vedic Vēdākshara

Every **Vedic Vēdākshara** (*Vēda-akṣara*) is accompanied by **śikṣā**, that is, a discipline of precise pronunciation, defined temporal rhythm, and tonal variation. Each Vēdākshara is bound with *svara* (intonation), exhibiting transitions from *udātta* (elevated tone) to *svarita* (mixed tone), and from *svarita* to *anudātta* (low tone). The *prāṇa* (life-force) adheres to the Vēdākshara, supplying the necessary air and energy during the act of pronunciation.
The **mind remains affixed** to each Vēdākshara without exceeding its prescribed duration of utterance.
The **source of the Vēdākshara's expression** is the *mūla-jñāna*, the original knowledge itself.

Scriptural Reference

"ऋचो अक्षरे परमे व्योमन्"
- *RigVēda* 1.164.39; *AtharvaVēda* 3.10.18; *Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa* 3.10.9.14; *Taittirīya Āraṇyaka* 2.11.1
Here, **Ṛc** (ऋच्) consists of:

- *ṛ-kāra*: symbolizing **Brahman**,
- *ca-kāra*: representing the **seat of Indra's power**.

Hence, *Ṛc* denotes the transformation of **Brahman into divine consciousness**. The Vēdākshara (*akṣara*) itself embodies this divine manifestation - Brahman assuming the form of divine power.
Paramam refers to the **living being (jīva)**, governed by the mind and existing through the three bodies.
Vyoman signifies the **meeting point** of speech (*vāk*), effort (*yathna*), mind (*manas*), and knowledge (*jñāna*).

Thus, "ऋचो अक्षरे परमे व्योमन" expresses that the **divine Vēdākshara**, in which Brahman manifests as divinity, resides at the convergence of speech, mind, and knowledge - the domain where all efforts are directed, the locus of Indra's energy.

Philosophical Implication
The **Vēda declares** that every Vēdākshara possesses an inherent **divine consciousness**. However, human beings no longer employ these Vēdāksharas for divine realization; rather, they use them merely for naming familiar objects, describing actions, or expressing imagination.
The **Vedic mantra**, however, is not intended for such mundane usage. Its true purpose is the **revelation of the divine consciousness** embedded within each Vēdākshara.

The Power of the Vēdākshara
What, then, is the divine energy latent within the Vēdākshara?
It is that which, emanating from the supreme *Vyoma* (spiritual space), descends through conscious or unconscious effort accompanied by knowledge, until it reaches the domain of articulated speech (*vāk yantra*), where it becomes **audible to perception**.
Hence, the Vēdākshara (*akṣara*) is the **sonic embodiment of divine energy**, a form of power beyond human control, the **power of the deities themselves**.
To contemplate a Vēdākshara, therefore, is to **envision and meditate upon the divine force concealed behind it**.
This process of profound reflection constitutes **tapas** - spiritual discipline and realization.

Discussion

In this section we will show some important statements given in the introduction and give methods and references that will be discussed in the next section.
During the act of articulation, the vital breath (*prāṇa*) provides the requisite flow of air corresponding to each tone and duration. Thus, *prāṇa* remains inherently connected with the Vēdākshara, sustaining it through the unity of breath, sound, and consciousness.
The statement "The Vēdākshara is accompanied by phonetic discipline" emphasizes that each Vēdākshara (*akṣara*) in the Vēda is bound by a precise science of pronunciation (*śikṣā*). This phonetic discipline ensures that the **temporal, tonal, and breath-related dimensions** of utterance are harmonized to preserve both sound and meaning.
In Vedic recitation, **the duration of utterance (uccāraṇa kāla)** is strictly determined. Each Vēdākshara must be articulated for a specific length of time. Additionally, every Vēdākshara possesses a **distinct tonal quality or pitch variation (svara-bheda)**, which follows the gradations of *udātta* (raised tone), *svarita* (middle tone), and *anudātta* (lower tone). These tonal modulations are not merely musical inflections but are metaphysical signifiers, symbolizing the dynamic flow of cosmic energy through sound.
The passage also connects the act of pronunciation to the **vital breath (*prāṇa*)**, indicating that proper phonation depends upon supplying the exact amount of breath corresponding to the tone and duration of the Vēdākshara. The *prāṇa* adheres to the *akṣara*, binding life-force and sound together as one continuous movement. Through this unity, **speech becomes a vehicle of consciousness**, and the Vedic word transforms from ordinary sound into a sacred vibration charged with divine energy.
Thus, the Vedic Vēdākshara is not a mere linguistic unit - it is a **living embodiment of rhythm, breath, and consciousness**, revealing the disciplined relationship between sound (śabda), life (prāṇa), and knowledge (jñāna).
In essence the Vedic Vēdākshara (*Vēdākṣara*) is accompanied by *Śikṣā* - the discipline of phonetics. This implies that its pronunciation follows a precisely determined duration. Each Vēdākshara is endowed with tone and governed by variations in intonation. Within every Vēdākshara, distinctions of pitch (*svara-bheda*) exist. The tonal progression moves from *udātta* (the raised tone) to *svarita* (the middle tone), and from *svarita* to *anudātta* (the lowered tone), indicating a continuous modulation in sound [Method-1, Ref (1)].

Brahman as the divine dimension of the Vēdākshara:
The passage begins by asserting that **Brahman**, the ultimate reality in Vedic philosophy, manifests as the **divine aspect of the Vēdākshara (ākṣara)**. In Vedic thought, Vēdāksharas are not mere sounds,they are **sacred vibrations (nāda)** that contain cosmic power. Here, Brahman is described not in abstract, but **immanently**: present within sound itself. This emphasizes the Vedic notion that language and sound are **vehicles of divine reality**.

Integration of speech, mind, and knowledge:
The passage then states that Brahman "resides within the union of speech, mind, and knowledge in the individual." This refers to the Vedic idea that the **human faculties of cognition and expression** specifically:

- **Speech (Vāk):** the ability to articulate, communicate, and manifest thought.
- **Mind (Manas):** the faculty of reflection, perception, and awareness.
- **Knowledge (Jñāna):** the comprehension of truths, both worldly and transcendental.

Brahman's presence in this triad implies that the **divine is not external alone but also embedded in human consciousness**, especially in the processes by which we think, speak, and understand.

"This locus represents the culmination of all effort":
This phrase indicates that the **integration of mind, speech, and knowledge is the highest point of human striving**. In Sanskrit terms, this could be related to **sādhana**, disciplined spiritual or intellectual effort. The passage identifies this integration as the **seat of Indra's power**, suggesting that the same **cosmic energy that governs the heavens (Indra being the Vedic deity of sovereignty and power)** is at work here. Symbolically, **Indra represents mastery, control, and divine potency**, which are realized when human faculties align with cosmic order.

Vēda articulating the divine in the Vēdākshara:
Finally, the passage notes that **the Vēda expresses the presence of the divine consciousness within the Vēdākshara**. This captures a core Vedic principle: that **sound, especially the mantras of the Vēdas, is not arbitrary but imbued with divine essence**. Each Vēdākshara, when properly intoned, is a **medium through which consciousness encounters Brahman**. In other words, **Vedic mantras are simultaneously linguistic and metaphysical realities**, acting as both instruction and revelation.

Philosophical significance:
Overall, the passage conveys a deeply **non-dualistic metaphysics**, where the **sacred, the human, and the cosmic converge**:

- The **microcosm (human mind, speech, knowledge)** mirrors the **macrocosm (Brahman, Indra's power)**.
- Spiritual effort is not only ethical or ritual but **linguistic and cognitive**, realized through **precise engagement with sound and consciousness**.
- The Vēda is both a **repository of knowledge and a living articulation of divine presence**, particularly through **Vēdāksharas imbued with Brahman**.

In essence Brahman is manifested as the divine aspect of the Vēdākshara, residing within the union of speech, mind, and knowledge in the individual being. This locus represents the culmination of all effort, essentially, the seat of Indra's power. Within the Vēdākshara, the Vēda conveys the presence of the divine consciousness [Method-2, Ref (2)].
The Vedic mantra is not merely a sequence of sounds or a phonetic utterance; rather, it is **a manifestation intended to reveal and convey the divine essence that resides within the Vēdākshara itself**. In the Vedic worldview, Vēdāksharas (ākṣaras) are not simply linguistic units, they are **vibrational carriers of cosmic energy**, capable of embodying and transmitting the presence of the divine. The question, then, arises: **what constitutes the divine power inherent within the Vēdākshara?**
This divine potency originates from the **supreme expanse of the cosmic ether (parama vyoma)**, representing the limitless and all-pervading reality of Brahman. Through deliberate and disciplined human

effort - through meditation, study, and engagement with the sacred texts, knowledge of this reality is pursued. Such effort is not merely intellectual; it involves the **integration of mind, speech, and comprehension**, aligning human faculties with cosmic principles.
As this knowledge progresses, it reaches the **instrument of speech (vāgyantra)**, the faculty through which thought is externalized and articulated. At this stage, the Vēdākshara becomes **audible and intelligible**, receptive to both recitation and attentive listening (śravaṇayoga). The act of listening, in this sense, is not passive, it is a form of **participation in the divine vibratory field of the Vēdākshara**.
Thus, the **power inherent in the Vēdākshara (ākṣara-śakti)** is realized at the intersection of cosmic origin, disciplined effort, and receptivity to sound. It is this power that makes the Vedic mantra a living vehicle of spiritual knowledge, enabling the practitioner to engage directly with the divine presence embedded within sacred sound. In short, the Vēdākshara functions as both **medium and manifestation**, linking the finite human consciousness with the infinite reality of Brahman.
In essence the Vedic mantra did not arise merely as a phonetic utterance; it was manifested to express the **divine essence inherent in the Vēdākshara**. What, then, is the nature of the divine power contained within the Vēdākshara? From the supreme expanse of the cosmic ether, through efforts that are both intentional and disciplined, knowledge is pursued and ultimately reaches the **instrument of speech (vāgyantra)**. It is at this juncture, receptive to the act of listening, that the **power inherent in the Vēdākshara** is realized [Method-3, Ref (3)].

Methods:
Method-1:
RigVēda (1-45-1)

- **देवता:** अग्निर्देवाः
- **ऋषि:** प्रस्कण्वः काण्वः
- **छन्द:** भुरिगुष्णिक्
- **स्वर:** ऋषभः

त्वम॑ग्ने॒ वसू॑रि॒ह रु॒द्राँ आ॑दि॒त्याँ उ॒त । यजा॑ स्वध्व॒रं जनं॒ मनु॑जातं घृत॒प्रुष॑म् ॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-45-1):
O Agni! You here bring forth the Vasus, the Rudras, and the Ādityas, and you cause to arise the **yajna that is free from animal slaughter**, performed by human beings and sanctified with the libation of clarified butter (*ghṛta*). You are thus the source and the performer of the pure and life-sustaining yajna.

Proposition

- **Question:** Who is addressed in this mantra?
  Answer: The deity **Agni** is addressed, who is invoked as the divine priest (*hotṛ*) and the mediator between the human and divine realms.
- **Question:** What divine groups does Agni bring forth in this mantra?
  Answer: Agni manifests and brings forth the **Vasus**, **Rudras**, and **Ādityas** - three classes of deities representing the elemental, transformative, and sustaining forces of the cosmos.
- **Question:** What type of sacrifice is mentioned here?
  Answer: The mantra refers to a **sacrifice devoid of animal slaughter**, a ritual offering (*yajña*) that is pure, life-affirming, and conducted with the libation of clarified butter (*ghṛta*).
- **Question:** Who performs this sacrifice?
  Answer: The **human beings (manuṣyāḥ)** perform the sacrifice, signifying the human participation in maintaining the cosmic order (*ṛta*) through acts of devotion and purity.
- **Question:** What is Agni's role in this context?
  Answer: Agni is both the **source and the performer** of the sacrifice. He gives birth to the sacred

act itself, sanctifies it with divine energy, and carries the human offering to the gods, thereby sustaining the bond between the mortal and the divine.

- **Question:** What is the philosophical implication of this mantra?
  Answer: The mantra highlights **Agni's central role as the embodiment of divine intelligence and purity**, transforming human action into spiritual realization. It emphasizes that true **sacrifice is one of knowledge, light, and purity**, free from violence, and conducted in harmony with cosmic order.

Conclusion of Method-1:
Thus, the tonal precision of the Vēdākṣara is not merely a linguistic or phonetic requirement, but a metaphysical principle reflecting the rhythmic harmony of the cosmos. Through the regulated modulation of sound, the reciter aligns individual consciousness with the cosmic order (ṛta), transforming pronunciation into an act of sacred participation in the universal vibration of Brahman.

Method-2:
RigVēda (1-164-39)

- **देवता:** विश्वेदेवा:
- **ऋषि:** दीर्घतमा औचथ्यः
- **छन्द:** भुरिक्त्रिष्टुप्
- **स्वर:** धैवतः

ऋचो अक्षरे परमे व्योमन्यस्मिन्देवा अधि विश्वे निषेदुः। यस्तन्न वेद किमृचा करिष्यति य इत्तद्विदुस्त इमे समासते ॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-164-39):
In those in whom the Rigvedic Mantras do not perish, the Supreme Self pervades all, just as the sky encompasses everything. In such beings, the deities and the wise (vidvānsa) remain firmly established in their full measure.
For those who are unable to realize this, what can the RigVēda accomplish?
Only those scholars who comprehend the Supreme Brahman truly understand these Mantras. They alone are firmly established in the Supreme Self.

Proposition:

- **Question**: What does the Preservation of the Rigvedic Mantras do?
  Answer: The Mantra begins with the statement that in certain individuals, the Rigvedic Mantras (ṛkṣa) do not perish. This implies that true understanding or internalization of the Vēda is not merely verbal recitation; it is the enduring assimilation of its spiritual and metaphysical truths.
- **Question**: In whom does the Supreme Self pervade?
  Answer: In such individuals, the Supreme Self (Paramātma or Brahman) is said to pervade everything like the sky, indicating that their consciousness is aligned with universal consciousness. Just as the sky contains and envelops all things without obstruction, the mind of a realized person is saturated with the divine.
- **Question**: In whom does Deities and the wise firmly established?
  Answer: The Mantra emphasizes that in the Supreme, the deities (devatās) and the learned sages (vidvānsa) remain firmly established. This can be interpreted as the harmonious functioning of divine forces and wisdom within the realized individual, suggesting perfect integration of spiritual knowledge, ethical conduct, and cosmic order.
- **Question**: Is there some use of limitation of mere recitation?
  Answer: The passage clearly distinguishes between external recitation of the RigVēda and internal realization of its truths. It asks rhetorically: "For those who do not comprehend the

Supreme, what can the RigVēda accomplish?" This highlights that the sacred Mantras have efficacy only when understood and internalized, not merely chanted.

- **Question**: What is the Role of the scholar or knower of Brahman?
  Answer: Only those who truly comprehend the Supreme Brahman - through knowledge, insight, and realization can grasp the full meaning of the Mantras. Such individuals are said to be firmly established in the Supreme Self, meaning their consciousness is unshakably aligned with the ultimate reality, and they embody the truths conveyed in the Vedic texts.

Conclusion of Method-2:
In conclusion, the Vedic Vēdākshara is not a mere sound but a living embodiment of divine power, bridging the infinite cosmic reality and human consciousness. Through disciplined effort, attentive listening, and the proper use of speech, the inherent potency of the Vēdākshara is realized, allowing the practitioner to experience and internalize the divine essence. Thus, the Vedic mantra functions simultaneously as vehicle and manifestation of spiritual knowledge, revealing the profound unity of sound, mind, and the Supreme Self.

Method-3:
RigVēda (10-25-5)

- **देवता:** सोमः
- **ऋषि:** विमद ऐन्द्रः प्राजापत्यो वा वसुकृद्वा वासुक्रः
- **छन्द:** निचृदार्षीपङ्क्ति
- **स्वर:** पञ्चमः

तव॒ त्ये सो॑म॒ शक्ति॑भि॒र्निका॑मासो॒ व्यृ॑ण्विरे । गृत्स॑स्य॒ धीरा॑स्त॒वसो॒ वि वो॒ मदे॑ व्र॒जं गोम॑न्तम॒श्विनं॒ विव॑क्षसे ॥

Essence of RigVēda (10-25-5):
O Soma! Those wise and steadfast seekers who yearn for you become endowed with strength and wisdom. Through the powers of the intelligent one, they attain an abundance of cattle, the company of horsekeepers, and other forms of excellence. Within you, the Supreme Self is distinctly present, abiding in the joy of all beings.

Proposition:

- **Question:** Who desires the powers inherent in the Vēdākshara (*akṣara-śaktis*)?
  Answer: The learned and powerful scholars (*śaktiśālī vidvānsaḥ*).
- **Question:** In this mantra, what is the divine potency present within the Vēdākshara?
  Answer: It is the radiant cluster of "cow-rays" (*go-kiraṇa-samūha*), symbolizing the luminous energies of knowledge, and the intelligent charioteer or horsekeeper (*aśva-pālaka*), representing the dynamic forces of the senses (*indriya-śakti*).
- **Question:** How can one perceive or intuit the power that lies behind the Vēdākshara?
  Answer: The wise, who seek the Supreme Self (*Paramātman*), attain the intelligent charioteer, the sensory power, which is uniquely established in the joy of all beings. This realization itself constitutes the perception of the power that operates behind the Vēdākshara.
- **Question:** What becomes manifest through the expression of the divine essence (*devatā-bhāva*) of Soma?
  Answer: The powerful and learned ones experience the **distinct joy bestowed by the exalted Vēdākshara energies**.
  The phonetic and symbolic components - 'ya' (effort), 'a' (primordial power), 'i' (indicator of time or movement), and 'va' (Vedic speech), together signify the statement *ya evam Vēda*, meaning "he who thus knows." Through this knowledge, they attain mastery in **phonetics (*śikṣā*), grammar**

(*vyākaraṇa*), and wisdom (*jñāna*), all of which arise from the realization of the intrinsic divine potency within the Vēdākshara.

Conclusion of Method-3:
The Vedic mantra did not emerge merely as an articulation of sound; rather, it was revealed for the purpose of **expressing the divine consciousness inherent within the Vēdākshara (akṣara)**. What, then, constitutes the divine potency within the Vēdākshara? From the supreme expanse of the cosmic ether (*parama vyoma*), through an effort that transcends ordinary human striving, knowledge descends and accompanies the current of consciousness until it reaches the **instrument of speech (*vāg-yantra*)**. It is at this point, where sound becomes audible and receptive to hearing, that the intrinsic power of the Vēdākshara manifests itself.
This metaphysical process and the nature of the Vēdākshara power have been examined and demonstrated through the authority of the RigVēda (10-25-5), which provides scriptural foundation for this interpretation.

Conclusion:

The Vēdākṣara is not merely a phonetic unit but a **cosmic principle**, embodying the convergence of sound, consciousness, and the divine. Arising from the supreme expanse of the cosmic ether, it channels transcendent knowledge into human speech, while the discipline of **Śikṣā** ensures tonal precision and temporal harmony, aligning the reciter with universal order (*ṛta*). In this way, the Vedic mantra functions both as a **vehicle of divine revelation** and as the **manifestation of metaphysical truth**, enabling the practitioner to experience the unity of speech, mind, and the Supreme Self.

References

(1). RigVēda (1-45-1)
(2). RigVēda (1-164-39)
(3). RigVēda (10-25-5)